

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Bandana Pattern for Beginners

A triangle headwrap built entirely from double crochet, with ties long enough to knot at the back or the front.

Updated 2026 · US terms · One adult size, adjustable tie length



This bandana is a flat triangle worked in rows, using the same double crochet stitch from our [granny square tutorial](#) — just increasing every row instead of only at the corners. It's a quick, practical project once you're comfortable with the basics from our [easiest first projects guide](#).

MATERIALS

- 1–2 skeins worsted-weight cotton or cotton-blend yarn (about 150–200 yards)
- 5.0mm (US size H) crochet hook
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.

MEANS

ch	Chain
dc	Double crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
inc	2 dc in same stitch (increase)

New to abbreviations? Our [abbreviations glossary](#) covers US and UK terms side by side.

GAUGE

Exact gauge isn't critical here — the triangle's finished width just depends on how many rows you work. As a rough guide, 12 dc and 8 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 5.0mm hook and worsted yarn.

NOTES

- Written in US terms. See our [abbreviations glossary](#) if you usually work in UK terms.
- This pattern makes one adult size with an 18-row triangle. For a child size, stop increasing after 12–13 rows instead.
- Ties are worked as simple chains, then reinforced with a row of single crochet for extra strength against repeated knotting.

Pattern

ROW 1

Chain 4. Dc in the 4th chain from hook. (2 sts)

ROW 2

Ch 3 (counts as first dc), turn. Inc in first st, dc in next st, inc in last st. (4 sts)

ROWS 3–18

Ch 3 (counts as first dc), turn. Inc in first st, dc across to last st, inc in last st. Each row adds 2 sts. (6, 8, 10 sts... *continuing by 2 each row until row 18*)

By row 18, you should have 36 sts across the widest edge. Fasten off, leaving a long tail for the border.

BORDER AND TIES

Rejoin yarn at one bottom corner (a short point of the triangle). Chain 60 for the first tie. Sl st back into the same corner to reinforce, then sc evenly along the entire diagonal edge, across the wide top edge, and down the other diagonal edge to the opposite corner. Chain 60 for the second tie, then sl st back into that corner.

FINISHING

Fasten off and weave in all ends with a yarn needle. Tie can be worn knotted at the back of the head, or crossed and tied at the front.

Frequently asked questions

How do I make a crochet bandana bigger or smaller?

Work more or fewer increase rows before starting the ties. Each additional row adds width to the triangle, so stop increasing once the widest edge measures close to your desired finished width.

What yarn works best for a crochet bandana?

A cotton or cotton-blend worsted-weight yarn holds its shape well and doesn't stretch out of shape the way some acrylics can, which matters for something tied

and worn repeatedly.

Can I make a matching bandana for a child and an adult?

Yes, this pattern scales down easily for a child size by working fewer increase rows before starting the ties, and shortening the tie length by a few inches.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.